

Triggers & Email Templates

Viral Ideas Marketing

Two-funnel signal taxonomy + Email 1 / Email 2 system
v2 — rebuilt against Discovery Questionnaire (May 2026)

Generated 2026-05-16

Prepared by Outreach Magic / Kinetyca

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What This Is

The complete signal taxonomy and email template system for Viral Ideas Marketing outbound, rebuilt against the Discovery Questionnaire (May 2026). Structure modeled on BIGVU's Campaign 198 (2.0% reply rate, 40 interested across 25K sends).

Two parallel funnels run different copy with different case studies and different pain language:

- **Funnel A — Half-Time tier** — mid-market marketing managers (Sierra) + growth marketers at funded startups (Lindsey)
- **Funnel B — Full-Time tier** — agency owners and CEOs (Daniel), white-label friendly

Enterprise pharma marketing directors (Brittany) and B2B founders (Adam) are opportunistic plays, not the main paid spend. They get their own light track.

The Two Funnels

Field	Funnel A	Funnel B
Tier	Half-Time	Full-Time
Buyer archetype	Sierra (mid-market marketing manager) + Lindsey (growth marketer at funded startup)	Daniel (agency CEO/Founder, 30-150 staff)
Buyer revenue band	\$50M-\$500M B2C/B2B (Sierra) · \$5M-\$50M startup (Lindsey)	\$5M-\$50M agency
Volume promise	8-20 videos/month, first drafts in 24 hours	30+ videos/month, same-day first drafts, white-label
Trigger words	"ghosted," "fire drill," "drowning," "we keep starting over," "I need a real team, not a freelancer"	"white-label," "dedicated editor," "the client noticed," "we need someone who can ramp without us teaching them everything"
Case study	Self Financial (marketing mgrs) · Gainbridge (growth marketers)	Clever Digital Marketing
Hook angle	Save your week. Stop being the bottleneck. CMO stops asking about video.	Margin recovery. Renewal protection. Client never knows we exist.

Opportunistic tracks (not main spend)

Archetype	Real example	Case study	Hook angle
Brittany — enterprise pharma mkt director	Ontada (McKesson subsidiary)	Ontada / Janssen / J&J	"Approval friendly, on-brand at scale, no surprises in front of leadership"
Adam — B2B founder, pro services/SaaS	Asset Map (VI client since 2017)	Asset Map	"Strategic partner, not just an editor. Built for compounding LTV."

Signal Mix

The signal-finding logic runs in two prompts. Both apply to both funnels — the SIGNAL is the same, but the CASE STUDY and PAIN LANGUAGE swap based on which funnel the prospect maps to.

Prompt A — Pharma-specific signals

Run first when the lead is in pharma, biotech, healthcare, or med device. Stop at first match. If no signal found, fall through to Prompt B.

#	Signal	Recency
A1	FDA approval / new indication / new device approval	last 90 days
A2	Clinical trial milestone / Phase III readout / endpoint announcement	last 90 days
A3	Upcoming medical congress with accepted abstract (ASH, ASCO, AHA, ESMO, AAD, ACR, AAOS, BIO, JPM)	next 60 days
A4	Currently using named pharma video agency (Klick, Razorfish Health, Ogilvy Health, EVERSANA, Greater Than One, Real Chemistry, FCB Health, McCann Health)	last 12 months

Prompt B — Universal signals

Run for ALL leads. Stop at first match.

#	Signal	Recency	Hit rate
B1	Open job posting for video / content / marketing production role	30d	~15-25%
B1.5	Freelance video editor 'open to work' who lists target company as recent client	30d	~5-10% — direct ghosting signal (strongest Funnel A trigger)
B2	New marketing / brand / content leader hired	90d	~20-30%
B3	Underutilized long-form footage on brand channel (15+ min video, no <2-min cuts on social)	120d	~50-70%
B4	Image-heavy LinkedIn brand page (<3 videos in 120d)	120d	~60-80%
B5	Recent company growth / expansion / new client win announcement	90d	~25-40%
B6	Recent funding / growth milestone	90d	~10-25%
B7	Agency RFP / RFQ posted for video editing (Funnel B only)	30d	~3-5% (strongest Funnel B trigger)
B8	Quarterly renewal-cycle boundary (Funnel B only)	calendar	~25% of agency leads/qtr
B9	Lead's most recent LinkedIn activity (guaranteed fallback)	30d	~85-95%

Email 1 — Template

Subject: [trigger-anchored 2-4 word lowercase subject]

Hi [First Name],

[TRIGGER -- specific observation about the prospect, tied to the signal that fired].

[PAIN -- what specifically hurts, using VOC language from the funnel's pain word library].

[SOLUTION -- named workflow + measurable outcome (see Strong Solution Pattern below). NOT a feature list.]

Worth a look for [Company]?

Word target: 70-110 words. No em dashes. No exclamation marks. No spam words. No bracket placeholders. No apologetic PS. No in-body taglines. NO sign-off -- email ends at the CTA. Signature handled by EmailBison {SENDER_EMAIL_SIGNATURE} system variable.

Subject line pattern (click-bait, still on-brand)

2-4 words, lowercase, **curiosity-driven**. The strongest subjects fall into 4 buckets:

Pattern	Examples
Before [their action] — implies an alternative they haven't considered	before you hire · before the hire
After [their event] — implies "and now what?"	after the raise · after the approval · after the win
Their [thing], [twist] — possessive + intriguing modifier	your [topic], untouched · your q4 book · your freelancer gap
Time-bound reference — specific window the prospect is in	first 90 days · six week sprint

Avoid: urgency ("now," "closing"), hype ("revolutionary," "game-changing"), generic ("quick question," "video editing services").

CTA swaps depending on intent

- **Default:** "Worth a look for [Company]?"
- **High-commitment signal** (FDA approval, funding round): "Open to a 15-minute diagnostic?" — matches VI's Doctor Frame sales method

Strong Solution Pattern (the part most cold emails get wrong)

A weak solution is a feature list ("dedicated editor, fast drafts, good QA"). A strong solution names a workflow, a tool, and a measurable outcome. Three components, in order:

- **1. Named case-study client + how they specifically use VI** — output volume, channel, deliverable type. ("Self Financial runs 12 videos a month through our pod.")
- **2. A specific workflow step OR a measurable outcome** — name the tool, the handoff, or the moment something becomes true. ("Their editor learned the brand from the kit handoff and was catching brand drift by video 3.")

- **3. SLA + tool + QA gate** — name the time, the tool, and the quality step. ("Drafts back in 24 hours through Frame.io with timestamped notes, every cut clears a Project Manager QC pass.")

If a sentence in the solution could be said by any video vendor, cut it. "We have dedicated editors and fast drafts" describes 50 competitors. "The editor was catching brand drift by video 3" describes Viral.

Trigger → Pain → Solution Library — Funnel A

Buyer: Sierra (mid-market marketing manager) + Lindsey (growth marketer at funded startup). **Case study to cite:** Self Financial (Sierra archetype) for marketing managers; Gainbridge (Lindsey archetype) for growth marketers.

Signal	Subject	Trigger	Pain	Solution (named workflow + outcome)
B1 Job posting	before you hire	"Saw [Company] is hiring a Video Editor."	"Most of our clients came to us right after a freelancer ghosted before a launch or a quarterly review. The math on hiring full-time usually doesn't survive a slow quarter either."	"Self Financial runs their video through our pod. The editor learned the brand from the kit handoff and was catching brand drift by video 3. Drafts back in 24 hours through Frame.io with timestamped notes, every cut clears a Project Manager QC pass before it ships."
B1.5 Freelancer ghosting	your freelancer gap	"Saw [Freelancer] just listed themselves as open to work after working with [Company]."	"Almost every team that comes to us starts with a freelancer who ghosted right before a launch. The pattern is consistent enough we built the model around it."	"Self Financial runs their video through our pod. After the brand-training week, the editor caught a brand-color misuse their last freelancer had shipped twice. Drafts back in 24 hours through Frame.io, Slack inside the hour, no ticket portal."
B2 New marketing leader	first 90 days	"Congrats on the [Role] start at [Company]."	"First 90 days for most marketing leaders means an audit of the content stack while the calendar keeps moving. The brief intake usually gets sloppy and video falls behind first."	"Self Financial runs their content production through our pod for exactly this. Brand kit captured on call one, locked into a templates library the editor pulls from. By video 3, the editor was catching brand drift before their marketing lead saw it. First drafts back in 24 hours."
B3 Underutilized long-form	your [topic], untouched	"I saw [Company]'s recent [Topic] interview on the brand channel. [X] minutes of long-form sitting on YouTube."	"Most teams sit on long-form like this for weeks before short-form ships, because the freelancer rotation keeps starting over with every new brief."	"Self Financial sends one long-form a month. We ship 8 to 10 branded short-form cuts in 5 business days. Captions, brand kit, and platform-specific aspect ratios built into the workflow. Every cut clears a PM QC pass before it goes back."

Signal	Subject	Trigger	Pain	Solution (named workflow + outcome)
B6 Funding (growth mkter)	after the raise	"Congrats on [Company]'s Series [X] last month."	"Growth-stage rounds usually mean creative supply becomes the bottleneck. Sales enablement, paid ads, recruiting content, and investor updates all need video at once, and hiring takes too long."	"Gainbridge, the growth team inside Group 1001 with about 160 billion in AUM, runs their paid-creative testing through our pod. New ad variants ship twice a week. Hook and retention feedback baked into every test, so the editor knows what scored before shipping the next."

Trigger → Pain → Solution Library — Funnel B

Buyer: Daniel (agency CEO/Founder, 30-150 staff, \$5M-\$50M revenue). **Case study to cite:** Clever Digital Marketing (Daniel archetype, ~\$10M, ~80 staff, Canadian agency, white-label model).

Signal	Subject	Trigger	Pain	Solution (named workflow + outcome)
B1 Agency editor hire	before the hire	"Saw [Agency] is hiring a Senior Video Editor."	"Most agencies that come to us tried to hire their way out and the math broke. A full-time editor is dead weight on slow weeks, and the brand calendar doesn't pause while you ramp."	"Clever Digital Marketing, a Canadian agency running about 80 staff, runs our team behind their accounts white-label. The editor sits inside each client's Slack channel under their brand. Same-day first drafts on Full-Time, revisions tracked in Frame.io, every cut clears the account lead's QC pass before going client-facing."
B5 New client win	after the win	"Saw [Agency] just announced the [Client] win."	"New accounts pile onto an in-house editing team already at capacity. The existing accounts start asking pointed questions about turnaround."	"Clever Digital Marketing runs our team behind five of their accounts white-label. Each editor learned the client's brand from the kit handoff and was catching drift by the third project. Same-day first drafts, dedicated editor per account, Slack inside the hour. Their renewal book got cleaner. The clients never knew."
B7 Agency RFP for video	your video rfp	"Saw [Agency]'s RFP for video editing partners."	"Most agencies post the RFP because the current vendor's quality dropped when volume scaled. The brand stopped looking like the brand and the client noticed."	"Clever Digital Marketing runs our team white-label behind their accounts. One dedicated editor per account, brand kit captured on the first kit handoff. Same-day first drafts on Full-Time, no rotation, no quality dip when volume spikes. Every cut clears the account lead's QC pass before going client-facing."
B8 Q4 renewal cycle	your q4 book	"Q4 renewal cycle approaching for [Agency]."	"Most agencies hit the renewal cycle with one or two accounts already flagging video as a churn risk. The vendor scaled the team through a pool and the brand drifted."	"Clever Digital Marketing runs our team behind five of their accounts white-label. Dedicated editor per account, brand kit handed off on call one. By the third project, the editor was catching brand drift before the account lead saw it. Same-day first drafts on Full-Time, no surprises before quarterly business reviews."

Trigger → Pain → Solution — Opportunistic

Buyers: Brittany (enterprise pharma marketing director) + Adam (B2B founder, established pro services or SaaS). **Case studies:** Ontada / Janssen / J&J for pharma; Asset Map for founder-led pro services / SaaS.

Signal	Subject	Trigger	Pain	Solution (named workflow + outcome)
A1 FDA approval (Brittany)	after the approval	"Congrats on the FDA approval at [Company] last month."	"Most enterprise launches need approval-friendly volume that survives legal review on the first pass. Most vendors don't survive enterprise governance."	"Ontada, the McKesson healthcare-data subsidiary, runs their HCP and clinical-trial cuts through our pod. By the third project, the editor learned the compliance pattern: how their legal team flags claims, how their brand team catches color and font misuse, what triggers a redaction. A six-week cycle shrinks to two. Submissions clear legal first-pass more often than not."
A3 Medical congress (Brittany)	before [conference]	"Saw [Company]'s team is presenting at [Conference] next month."	"Congress content has a hard deadline and three audiences: HCP attendees, KOLs, and the field team. Most brand teams over-spec the deliverable count and under-deliver on quality."	"Janssen runs their congress content through our pod. One editor across the launch teaser, day-of clips, and recap series so the brand voice stays the same across all three. Regulatory QA built into the editor's workflow, every cut cleared before it goes to legal."
B5 Founder-led growth (Adam)	after the milestone	"Saw [Company]'s [milestone] announcement."	"Founder-led marketing functions at this stage usually hit a wall where the junior marketing lead is drowning and the strategic conversations stop happening because everyone's executing."	"Asset Map has been a Viral client since 2017. Their marketing lead has a partner who thinks about positioning, platform strategy, and what to ship next, not just an editor who takes orders. We were producing for them at Series A. Eight years later we're still producing."

Email 2 — Template (Lead-Magnet Pivot)

Same thread, ~3-5 days after Email 1. The broader observation in paragraph 1 pulls from the **5 reasons clients switch** (per discovery), funnel-matched to the prospect.

Subject: Re: [Email 1 subject]

[BROADER OBSERVATION -- funnel-matched, drawn from the 5 switching reasons].

Viral takes any long-form video and ships 5 short-form pieces in 5 business days. Branded, captioned, [audience-specific qualifier].

Interested in 5 short-form cuts from one of your existing [Company] long-forms? (on us)

Word target: 60-90 words

Broader observation library by signal type

Email 1 signal type	Funnel	Email 2 paragraph 1 observation
Freelancer ghosting / job posting	A	"Almost every team we work with came to us after a freelancer ghosted mid-campaign. The pattern is consistent enough we built the model around it."
Quality drift / new marketing leader	A	"The most common story we hear is great first month, quality slip by month four. Usually that means the vendor scaled the account through a pool. We don't run pools."
Funding / paid creative pain	A	"Most growth teams that come to us have run paid for a quarter on a 14-day refresh cycle that should have been 5. The vendor couldn't keep up."
Agency editor hire / RFP	B	"Most agencies come to us after a vendor that survived strategy meetings but missed the client deliverable date. The math at signup stops working by month three."
Agency renewal cycle / churn risk	B	"Most agencies that come to us have a renewal book with one or two accounts flagging video as a churn risk. The vendor scaled the team through a pool. We don't."
Enterprise pharma	Opportunistic	"Enterprise teams usually come to us after a vendor couldn't survive legal and brand-compliance review. We've built around the approval cycle, not against it."
Founder (Adam-shaped)	Opportunistic	"Founder-led marketing functions usually outgrow their vendor stack and don't notice until deals start slipping. We tend to stay 8+ years for that reason."

Audience-specific qualifier (Email 2 paragraph 2)

Funnel / signal type	Qualifier line
Funnel A — Sierra (mid-market)	"ready to post on LinkedIn or YouTube"
Funnel A — Lindsey (growth)	"ready for paid or organic"
Funnel B — Daniel (agency)	"ready to deliver under your label"
Opportunistic — Brittany (pharma)	"regulatory-aware"

Funnel / signal type	Qualifier line
Opportunistic — Adam (founder)	"positioned for the next phase"

Rendered Examples

Six prospect pairs, fully resolved Email 1 + Email 2 ready to send. No placeholders. Pulled across all funnels.

Prospect 1 — Maya Reyes, Senior Marketing Manager, Step

Funnel A · Signal B1 (job posting)

Email 1

Subject: before you hire

Hi Maya, saw Step is hiring a Video Editor. Most of our clients came to us right after a freelancer ghosted before a launch or a quarterly review. The math on hiring full-time usually doesn't survive a slow quarter either.

Self Financial runs their video through our pod. The editor learned the brand from the kit handoff and was catching brand drift by video 3. Drafts back in 24 hours through Frame.io with timestamped notes, every cut clears a Project Manager QC pass before it ships.

Worth a look for Step?

Email 2

Subject: re: before you hire

Almost every team we work with came to us after a freelancer ghosted mid-campaign. The pattern is consistent enough we built the model around it.

Viral takes any long-form video and ships 5 short-form pieces in 5 business days. Branded, captioned, ready to post on LinkedIn or YouTube.

Interested in 5 short-form cuts from one of your existing Step long-forms? (on us)

Prospect 2 — Tom Diaz, Head of Growth, Mercury

Funnel A · Signal B6 (Series C funding)

Email 1

Subject: after the raise

Hi Tom, congrats on Mercury's Series C last quarter. The 90 days after a round usually mean creative supply becomes the bottleneck. Sales enablement, paid ads, recruiting content, and investor updates all need video at once, and hiring takes too long.

Gainbridge, the growth team inside Group 1001 with about 160 billion in AUM, runs their paid-creative testing through our pod. New ad variants ship twice a week. Hook and retention feedback baked into every test, so the editor knows what scored before shipping the next.

Open to a 15-minute diagnostic?

Email 2

Subject: re: after the raise

Most growth teams that come to us have run paid for a quarter on a 14-day refresh cycle that should have been 5. The vendor couldn't keep up.

Viral takes any long-form video and ships 5 short-form pieces in 5 business days. Branded, captioned, ready for paid or organic.

Interested in 5 short-form cuts from one of your existing Mercury long-forms? (on us)

Prospect 3 — Sarah Chen, CEO, Anomaly

Funnel B · Signal B1 (agency editor hire)

Email 1

Subject: before the hire

Hi Sarah, saw Anomaly is hiring a Senior Video Editor. Most agencies that come to us tried to hire their way out and the math broke. A full-time editor is dead weight on slow weeks, and the brand calendar doesn't pause while you ramp.

Clever Digital Marketing, a Canadian agency running about 80 staff, runs our team behind their accounts white-label. The editor sits inside each client's Slack under their brand. Same-day first drafts on Full-Time, revisions in Frame.io, every cut clears the account lead's QC pass before going client-facing.

Worth a look for Anomaly?

Email 2

Subject: re: before the hire

Most agencies come to us after a vendor that survived strategy meetings but missed the client deliverable date. The math at signup stops working by month three.

Viral takes any long-form video and ships 5 short-form pieces in 5 business days. Branded, captioned, ready to deliver under your label.

Interested in 5 short-form cuts from one of your existing client long-forms? (on us)

Prospect 4 — Jessica Park, VP Marketing, Cala Health

Funnel A · Signal B2 (new marketing leader)

Email 1

Subject: first 90 days

Hi Jessica, congrats on the VP Marketing start at Cala Health. First 90 days for most marketing leaders means an audit of the content stack while the calendar keeps moving. The brief intake usually gets sloppy and video falls behind first.

Self Financial runs their content production through our pod for exactly this. Brand kit captured on call one, locked into a templates library the editor pulls from. By video 3, the editor was catching brand drift before their marketing lead saw it. First drafts back in 24 hours.

Worth a look for Cala?

Email 2

Subject: re: first 90 days

The most common story we hear is great first month, quality slip by month four. Usually that means the vendor scaled the account through a pool. We don't run pools.

Viral takes any long-form video and ships 5 short-form pieces in 5 business days. Branded, captioned, ready to post.

Interested in 5 short-form cuts from one of your existing Cala Health long-forms? (on us)

Prospect 5 — Rachel Park, Sr. Marketing Director, Eli Lilly Oncology

Opportunistic · Signal A1 (FDA approval)

Email 1

Subject: after the approval

Hi Rachel, congrats on the FDA approval at Lilly Oncology last month. Most enterprise launches need approval-friendly volume that survives legal review on the first pass. Most vendors don't survive enterprise governance.

Ontada, the McKesson healthcare-data subsidiary, runs their HCP and clinical-trial cuts through our pod. By the third project, the editor learned the compliance pattern: how their legal team flags claims, how their brand team catches color and font misuse, what triggers a redaction. A six-week cycle shrinks to two.

Open to a 15-minute diagnostic?

Email 2

Subject: re: after the approval

Enterprise teams usually come to us after a vendor couldn't survive legal and brand-compliance review. We've built around the approval cycle, not against it.

Viral takes any long-form video and ships 5 short-form pieces in 5 business days. Branded, captioned, regulatory-aware.

Interested in 5 short-form cuts from one of your existing Lilly long-forms? (on us)

Prospect 6 — Marcus Webb, COO, Sage Communications

Funnel B · Signal B5 + B8 (new client win + Q4 renewal cycle)

Email 1

Subject: your q4 book

Hi Marcus, saw Sage just announced the new client win. Most agencies hitting Q4 with new accounts and an in-house team already at capacity see existing clients start asking pointed questions about turnaround.

Clever Digital Marketing runs our team behind five of their accounts white-label. The editor learned each client's brand from the kit handoff and was catching brand drift by the third project. Same-day first drafts on Full-Time, Slack response inside the hour, every cut clears the account lead's QC pass before going client-facing.

Their renewal book got cleaner. Clients never knew.

Worth a look for Sage?

Email 2

Subject: re: your q4 book

Most agencies that come to us have a renewal book with one or two accounts flagging video as a churn risk. The vendor scaled the team through a pool. We don't.

Viral takes any long-form video and ships 5 short-form pieces in 5 business days. Branded, captioned, ready to deliver under your label.

Interested in 5 short-form cuts from one of your existing client long-forms? (on us)

VI Differentiator Library (rank-ordered by specificity)

Two tiers: **specific workflow elements** (best — they sound like nobody else's marketing) vs **generic claims** (use only if a specific one doesn't fit).

Tier 1 — Specific workflow + measurable outcomes (USE THESE FIRST)

Differentiator	When to use
"The editor learned the brand from the kit handoff and was catching brand drift by video 3"	Default — works in every signal. Most specific outcome we have.
"Brand kit captured on call one, locked into a templates library the editor pulls from"	New marketing leader (B2) or new-account-onboarding signals
"Drafts back in 24 hours through Frame.io with timestamped notes" (Funnel A) / "Same-day drafts on Full-Time through Frame.io" (Funnel B)	Speed pain + names the tool
"Every cut clears a Project Manager QC pass before it ships"	Quality-fear pain. Names the QA gate.
"The editor sits inside the client's Slack channel under their brand" (Funnel B)	Agency white-label signals
"After the brand-training week, the editor caught a brand-color misuse their last freelancer had shipped twice"	Post-freelancer-ghost signals
"By the third project, the editor learned the compliance pattern: how legal flags claims, how brand catches color and font misuse, what triggers a redaction"	Pharma / regulated environments
"A six-week cycle shrinks to two. Submissions clear legal first-pass more often than not"	Enterprise pharma (Brittany)
"New ad variants ship twice a week. Hook and retention feedback baked into every test, so the editor knows what scored before shipping the next"	Growth marketer (Lindsey) / paid creative pain
"One editor across the launch teaser, day-of clips, and recap series so the brand voice stays the same across the set"	Sprint deliverables (launch, congress, campaign)
"The cuts go out under your brand. The client never knows we exist."	Funnel B white-label
"We were producing for them at Series A. Eight years later we're still producing."	Founder (Adam) — long-LTV proof

Tier 2 — Generic claims (use ONLY if no Tier 1 fits)

Differentiator	When to use
"One dedicated editor, not a rotating pool"	Default fallback
"Slack response inside the hour Mon to Fri 9 to 5 EST"	Communication-collapse pain
"Unlimited revisions on the first batch until the baseline is right"	Quality-fear pain

Differentiator	When to use
"No ticket portal, no edit lottery, no autoresponder"	Vendor-collapse pain

Rule: If a sentence in the solution could be said by any subscription editing service, it's Tier 2 and probably needs to be replaced with a Tier 1 specific. Strong solutions name the workflow, the tool, the outcome, or all three.

VOC Language Library (prospect's own words)

Use these in pain lines. They sound like the prospect's own internal monologue.

All buyers say

"ghosted," "dropped the ball," "off brand," "inconsistent," "unreliable," "another fire drill," "I'm drowning," "out of bandwidth," "we keep starting over," "the last batch was rough," "I just need someone I can trust," "I can't keep doing this," "we can't scale this," "I need a real team, not a freelancer."

Agencies (Funnel B) say

"white-label," "dedicated editor," "we need someone who can ramp without us teaching them everything," "the client noticed."

Enterprise marketers (Brittany) say

"approval friendly," "on brand at scale," "we can't have surprises."

Copy Rules (Non-Negotiable)

Rule	Why
50-100 words per email (Email 1: 70-100, Email 2: 60-90)	Brand book grade 8-10 reading level. Above 100 words loses the buyer.
Subject: 2-4 words, lowercase, anchored to prospect-owned thing	"editor hire" beats "video production services for B2B SaaS"
Person and company names always capitalized	Even in lowercase subject lines
No em dashes	Use sentence breaks or commas
No exclamation marks	Brand book: calm and confident, never urgent
No spam words (especially "free")	Replace with "on us"
No "\$" symbol	Pricing belongs on the call, not in cold body
No bracket placeholders in final render	Every variable resolved before send
No "Best, [Name]" inside body	Signature handled by EmailBison {SENDER_EMAIL_SIGNATURE}
No apologetic PS	"If this isn't a fit..." reads insecure. Calm and confident only.
No in-body taglines	BIGVU bug to avoid — keep brand lines in signature, not body
Soft yes/no CTA in Email 1	"Worth a look for [Company]?" or "Open to a 15-min diagnostic?"
Lead magnet drops in Email 2 only	Email 1 teases the product. Email 2 offers the 5-cut pack.
Email 2 paragraph 1 pulls from the 5 switching reasons	Prospect feels understood ("they know what I went through")
Funnel-matched case study	Self Financial/Gainbridge for A · Clever Digital for B · Ontada/Asset Map for opportunistic
VOC language in pain lines	Use prospect's own words: ghosted, fire drill, drowning, white-label, approval friendly

Operational Pre-Requisites Before Launch

- **Sample delivery workflow.** When a prospect replies to Email 2, the team must deliver the 5-cut pack within 24-48 hours. Same single point of failure that broke BIGVU's funnel.
- **Funnel-matched case study assets.** Self Financial, Gainbridge, Clever Digital, Ontada, Asset Map — each needs a one-paragraph proof block. Hard outcome numbers are the gap (Dave to backfill 2-3 per case study).
- **Sender persona signature.** Name, brand, NYC location, phone number, website. Missing phone/address triggers scammer suspicion.
- **Signal-finder prompts deployed.** Prompt A + Prompt B in Clay or equivalent, priority-ordered evaluation.
- **Suppression list functional.** Negative replies, OOOs, prior unsubscribes feed back into Clay / EmailBison suppression.
- **Funnel-routing logic.** Lead's title + industry determines which funnel. Mid-market mkt mgr + growth marketer → Funnel A. Agency owner/CEO → Funnel B. Enterprise pharma + B2B founder → opportunistic.

Open Decisions for Dave Before Launch

- **Lead magnet for Email 2.** Current default is the 5-cut pack. Video Grader (self-service) is inbound. 15-min diagnostic is the Doctor Frame closer. Recommend 5-cut for cold, Diagnostic as Email 3.
- **Pricing transparency in cold copy.** Currently removed entirely. Recommend stay off pricing in cold, mention on call.
- **Hard outcome numbers per case study.** Dave owes 2-3 numbers per case study so proof line beats logos-only.
- **Coordination with existing Lead Hunter outbound** (vlad@leadhunter.net). Pause, parallel, or handoff?
- **Sender persona** — spin up a new Viral persona, do not reuse BIGVU's Sarah Stanfield.

Document version: v2 (2026-05-16) | github.com/matteof123/Viral